CONNECTED INTELLIGENCE

MASTER PROMPT TEMPLATE

Author the lens through which AI sees your world.

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Module 3
Exercise

How to Build Your Master Prompt

Your Master Prompt is the standing brief you give AI before every session. Build it once. Update it quarterly. It's not a fancy document — it's a complete description of who you are, what you're working on, and how you want to be helped.

The 6 Components

1. Role & Title

Who you are professionally. Your title, function, and the type of work you own. This sets AI's frame of reference for everything that follows — without it, AI defaults to generic advice.

2. Organization Context

What your org does, its size, industry, and stage (startup/growth/established/enterprise). Include your team structure and who you work with. AI can't infer what it doesn't know.

3. Current Projects

The 3–5 things you're actively working on right now. Be specific — project names, goals, timelines. This prevents AI from giving you generic advice when you need context-specific output.

4. Customer / Audience

Who you serve. Internal stakeholders, external clients, end users. Include their sophistication level, what they care about, and what frustrates them. This shapes tone and relevance automatically.

5. Communication Preferences

How you like output formatted — formal vs. casual, bullet vs. prose, length preferences. Include what you *don't* want: no buzzwords, no passive voice, no fluffy intros. Anti-preferences reduce editing time significantly.

6. Values & Constraints

What you won't compromise on. Budget constraints, legal guardrails, brand standards, ethical lines. Constraints aren't limitations — they're creative direction. They tell AI how to help you better, not less.

The AI Interview Prompt — paste this into ChatGPT or Claude:

"Interview me to create a master prompt for my role as [YOUR TITLE]. Ask me one question at a time about: my role and responsibilities, my organization and industry, my current projects and priorities, my audience and customers, my communication preferences, and my values and constraints. When we're done, synthesize everything into a master prompt document I can save and reuse."

Master Prompt — Example

This is a complete, production-ready master prompt. Use it as a calibration target — not a word-for-word template. Your version should reflect your actual work, voice, and constraints.

MASTER PROMPT — Sarah Chen, Director of Marketing

1. Role & Title: I'm Sarah Chen, Director of Marketing at Meridian Software. I own brand, demand gen, and content for a B2B SaaS company. I manage a team of 4 and report to the CMO.

2. Organization Context: Meridian builds practice management software for accounting and legal firms (50–500 employees). We're Series B, ~180 employees, growing 40% YoY. Main competitors are Clio and PracticePanther. Our differentiator is deep workflow automation — we save firms 6+ hours per week per professional. Sales cycle is 60–90 days, average contract is $28K/year.

3. Current Projects: (1) Q2 campaign — "The 6-Hour Week" — targeting law firm managing partners, live April 15. (2) Rebuilding content strategy around buyer journey stages — currently 80% top-of-funnel, need balance. (3) Onboarding a new content manager starting in 3 weeks. (4) Minor brand refresh (not a rebrand) — finalize by end of Q2.

4. Customer / Audience: Primary: managing partners and firm administrators at accounting + legal firms. Analytically minded, time-poor, skeptical of vendor claims, respond to ROI specifics. Secondary: IT leads who care about security, implementation, and support quality.

5. Communication Preferences: Plain, direct language — no buzzwords, no jargon. Bullets for anything actionable, short paragraphs for narrative. Skip fluffy intro sentences. Format for easy editing, not polished essays. When I ask for options, give me 3 and recommend one with a reason.

6. Values & Constraints: No claims we can't prove with data. Legal reviews anything with ROI numbers before it ships. I won't use manipulation tactics. Budget is tight — consider free/low-cost options first. Never name competitors in content we'd publish externally.

What Makes This Strong

- **Specific numbers** — 40% YoY growth, 60–90 day sales cycle, $28K contract. AI can now give proportionate, calibrated advice.
- **Named projects with dates** — AI can prioritize and flag when output is relevant to an active initiative.
- **Anti-preferences listed** — "No buzzwords," "skip the fluffy intro" reduces editing time on every output.
- **Constraints with reasons** — "Legal reviews ROI claims" tells AI both the rule and why, so it can flag proactively.

Your Master Prompt — Sections 1–3

Write your own. Don't aim for perfect — aim for complete. A rough, honest Master Prompt beats a polished vague one every time. Use the Voice-to-Context tip: set a 3-minute timer and talk out loud like you're explaining your work to a new hire, then paste and structure.

1. Role & Title

Your title, what you own, who you report to, who you manage.

2. Organization Context

What your org does, size, industry, stage, key competitors or context.

3. Current Projects

Your top 3–5 active projects — names, goals, timelines. Be specific.

Your Master Prompt — Sections 4–6

4. Customer / Audience

Who you serve, what they care about, what frustrates them, how they communicate.

5. Communication Preferences

Format preferences, tone, length. Include what you DON'T want AI to do.

6. Values & Constraints

What you won't compromise on. Budget limits, legal guardrails, brand standards, ethical lines.

Quality Checklist — before you save this

- ☐ Would a stranger understand my situation from reading this alone?
- ☐ Does it sound like me — my voice, my priorities, my actual work?
- ☐ Did I include constraints (budget, legal, brand, confidentiality)?
- ☐ Is anything too sensitive to paste into an AI tool? Remove or generalize it.